

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-06-25

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Nahum 1:1-8

1 The burden against Nineveh. The book of the vision of Nahum the Elkoshite.

2 God is jealous, and the Lord avenges; The Lord avenges and is furious. The Lord will take vengeance on His adversaries, And He reserves wrath for His enemies;

3 The Lord is slow to anger and great in power, And will not at all acquit the wicked. The Lord has His way In the whirlwind and in the storm, And the clouds are the dust of His feet.

4 He rebukes the sea and makes it dry, And dries up all the rivers. Bashan and Carmel wither, And the flower of Lebanon wilts.

5 The mountains quake before Him, The hills melt, And the earth heaves at His presence, Yes, the world and all who dwell in it.

6 Who can stand before His indignation? And who can endure the fierceness of His anger? His fury is poured out like fire, And the rocks are thrown down by Him.

7 The Lord is good, A stronghold in the day of trouble; And He knows those who trust in Him.

8 But with an overflowing flood He will make an utter end of its place, And darkness will pursue His enemies.

II. Key Summary

- The book of Nahum opens with a prophecy against Nineveh, the capital of Assyria — the same city that repented under Jonah's preaching a century earlier but had since returned to its ways (1:1).
 - Nahum declares God to be jealous and avenging, yet also "slow to anger and great in power," one who "will not at all acquit the wicked" (1:2-3).
 - Verse 7 pivots: "The LORD is good, a stronghold in the day of trouble; and He knows those who trust in Him" (1:7).
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III. Passage Analysis

"Slow to Anger" — Not Indifferent, but Holding Back

"God's sword of justice is in its scabbard: not rusted in it — it can be easily withdrawn — but held there by that hand that presses it back into its sheath, crying, 'Sleep, O sword, sleep; for I will have mercy upon sinners, and will forgive their transgressions.'"
[1]

Verse 3 puts two things in the same breath: "slow to anger" and "will not at all acquit the wicked." These don't cancel each other out — they say that God's patience is an active choice, and the sword is real. He waits because He cares, not because it doesn't matter.

"He Knows Those Who Trust in Him" — Not Just Noticing, but Really Knowing

"God knows us; he knows our prayers and tears, he knows our wishes, he knows that we are not what we want to be, but he knows what we do desire to be. He knows our aspirations, our sighs, our groans, our secret longings, our own chastenings of spirit when we fail; he has entered into it all." [2]

The word "knows" in verse 7 carries the weight of recognition, care, and relationship — not just observation. Mountains quake, rocks split, rivers run dry — but one thing stays constant: God knows the people who trust in Him.

IV. Reflection Question

Have you ever done something you knew was wrong and told yourself, "It's fine — God will forgive anyway"?

Nahum 1:3 says God is "slow to anger" — but in the same breath, He "will not at all acquit the wicked." His patience isn't permission; taking His time doesn't mean He didn't see.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/nahum-1/>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/nahum-1/>